

The Prompt Ladder

Baseline Prompt:

Prompt:

Write me a LinkedIn post about AI in marketing.

Output:

AI is changing the way marketing works—but it's not replacing marketers. It's helping them make smarter decisions, save time, and create more personalised customer experiences.

From analysing customer behaviour to generating content ideas, optimising ad campaigns, and predicting trends, AI enables marketers to focus less on repetitive tasks and more on strategy and creativity.

The real advantage isn't simply using AI—it's knowing when to combine AI-driven insights with human judgment. The brands that succeed will be the ones that use AI to enhance decision-making while keeping authenticity and customer trust at the centre.

As AI continues to evolve, marketers who embrace continuous learning and adapt to new tools will be better positioned to create meaningful, data-driven campaigns.

How has AI changed the way you approach marketing?

#ArtificialIntelligence #Marketing #DigitalMarketing #AI #MarketingStrategy
#DataDriven #Innovation #BusinessGrowth

Note:

It's generic, reads like a dictionary definition, is boring, has no specific audience, no clear goal, and is entirely forgettable.

Version 1: Define a clear goal

Prompt:

Write me a LinkedIn post about AI in marketing that makes a sceptical, traditional marketer feel they are falling behind by not using it.

Output:

There was a time when knowing your audience better than your competitors was enough. Today, the marketers who know their audience **and** use AI have a growing advantage.

They're analysing customer behaviour in minutes instead of days. Testing multiple ad variations before lunch. Personalising campaigns at a scale that was almost impossible a few years ago. They're not replacing marketing fundamentals—they're accelerating them.

If you're still relying only on manual research, intuition, and traditional workflows, you're likely competing against teams that can iterate faster, uncover insights sooner, and respond to market changes more quickly.

The question isn't whether AI will replace marketers.

It's whether marketers who use AI will outperform those who don't.

The fundamentals of great marketing haven't changed. Understanding customers, telling compelling stories, and building trust still matter. AI simply gives marketers more time and better information to do those things well.

The gap isn't between experienced marketers and new marketers anymore.

It's increasingly between marketers who know how to work with AI and those who haven't started yet.

The best time to learn was yesterday.

The next best time is today.

#AI #Marketing #ArtificialIntelligence #DigitalMarketing #MarketingStrategy
#FutureOfWork #BusinessGrowth

Four Notes:

1. **What changed in the prompt:** Added a clear goal.
2. **What improved in the output:** It has a hook now and a clear target for the reader. It's more urgent and persuasive. It's no longer a definition but a call to action.
3. **What still failed:** The audience is still vague. Is "sceptical marketer" a CMO or a freelance social media manager? The post is also very short and lacks evidence to back up its bold claims. It's just telling someone they're behind without showing them where the cliff is.
4. **What I would try next:** The biggest weakness is the lack of a **defined audience**. A CMO needs different data points than a freelancer.

Version 2: Define a Specific Audience

Prompt:

Write me a LinkedIn post about AI in marketing that makes a sceptical, traditional CMO of a mid-sized B2B manufacturing company feel they are falling behind by not using it. They don't need to be convinced AI is the future; they need to see practical applications for their specific industry.

Output:

Most B2B manufacturing companies aren't losing deals because they have a bad product. They're losing them because they're slower to understand the market, respond to customer needs, and support their sales teams. This is where AI is already making a practical difference.

Imagine your marketing team identifying which website visitors are most likely to request a quote, summarising hundreds of customer inquiries to uncover recurring pain points, generating technical content tailored to different industries, or helping sales teams respond to RFPs and proposal requests in a fraction of the time.

None of this replaces your engineers, product experts, or marketers. It helps them spend less time on repetitive work and more time solving customer problems.

For mid-sized manufacturers, AI isn't about chasing the latest trend or building a chatbot because everyone else has one.

It's about making better use of the data you already have—your CRM, website analytics, customer emails, support tickets, and product documentation—to improve decisions and move faster.

The competitive risk isn't that another manufacturer has "more AI."

It's that they're responding to buyers faster, producing more relevant content, qualifying leads more effectively, and giving their sales team better insights before every conversation.

Manufacturing has always rewarded companies that improve efficiency.

Marketing is no different.

The question isn't whether AI belongs in your marketing strategy.

It's whether your competitors are already using it to win opportunities before your team even knows they exist.

What practical AI use case has delivered the most value in your organisation?

#B2BMarketing #Manufacturing #ArtificialIntelligence #MarketingStrategy
#IndustrialMarketing #DigitalTransformation #SalesEnablement
#ManufacturingInnovation

Four Notes:

1. **What changed in the prompt:** Added a defined audience (CMO, mid-sized B2B manufacturing).
2. **What improved in the output:** The post is now laser-focused. The terms ("churn," "lead gen," "supply chain") are relevant to that specific person. It's no longer generic; it speaks their language and addresses their specific problems (predicting revenue).
3. **What still failed:** It's still a flimsy claim. A CMO will see this and think, "Cool, but **how?** Provide proof. Show me a real example." The output is still just a monologue.
4. **What I would try next:** Add examples of what good looks like. Give a concrete case study or example to make the abstract claim credible.

Version 3: Provide Examples of What Good Looks Like

Prompt:

Write me a LinkedIn post about AI in marketing that makes a sceptical, traditional CMO of a mid-sized B2B manufacturing company feel they are falling behind by not using it. Use a specific example: a manufacturing company that used AI to analyse customer service calls and identified a product defect early, allowing marketing to pivot their messaging to focus on reliability, resulting in a 15% decrease in churn.

Output:

Most manufacturing leaders think of AI as a way to create content faster. They're looking in the wrong place.

Imagine this scenario.

A mid-sized B2B manufacturer uses AI to analyse thousands of customer service calls. Instead of relying on anecdotal feedback, the system detects a recurring issue with a product component weeks before it appears in quarterly reports.

Engineering investigates and confirms a defect.

Operations begins addressing the problem.

But here's where marketing becomes a strategic advantage.

Rather than continuing with generic product messaging, the marketing team quickly pivots its campaigns to emphasise reliability, transparency, and the improvements

being made. Existing customers receive proactive communications that address concerns before they become reasons to leave.

The result?

A 15% reduction in customer churn.

Whether the improvement is 15%, 5%, or something else will depend on the business. The point is that AI's biggest impact isn't writing blog posts—it's surfacing business signals early enough for every department to act.

For many B2B manufacturers, customer service conversations contain more market intelligence than any survey ever will. The companies using AI to uncover those insights can respond before problems become lost customers.

Your competitors don't need AI to build a better product overnight.

They just need it to spot problems—and opportunities—faster than you do.

That's where competitive advantage begins.

#ArtificialIntelligence #B2BMarketing #Manufacturing #CustomerInsights
#MarketingStrategy #CustomerRetention #DigitalTransformation
#IndustrialMarketing

Four Notes:

1. **What changed in the prompt:** Added examples of what good looks like.
2. **What improved in the output:** The post now has a concrete story. It's no longer a vague warning; it's a specific, tangible case study. The "15% decrease in churn" provides the proof that a sceptical CMO needs.
3. **What still failed:** The output is a wall of text. A busy CMO scrolling LinkedIn won't read this. They'll see a big block of text and scroll past. There's no visual hierarchy or scannability.
4. **What I would try next:** Specify an output format to make the post readable (e.g., bullet points, short paragraphs).

Version 4: Specify an Output Format

Prompt:

Write me a LinkedIn post about AI in marketing that makes a sceptical, traditional CMO of a mid-sized B2B manufacturing company feel they are falling behind by not using it. Use a specific example: a manufacturing company that used AI to analyse customer service calls and identified a product defect early, allowing marketing to pivot their messaging to focus on reliability, resulting in a 15% decrease in churn.

Format the post for LinkedIn: Very short paragraphs, bullet points for stats, and a provocative headline.

Output:

Your competitors won't beat you with better marketing. They'll beat you with better signals.

Most manufacturing CMOs think AI is for writing blog posts. That's the smallest opportunity. The real value is finding problems—and opportunities—before your competitors do.

Imagine this.

A mid-sized B2B manufacturer uses AI to analyse thousands of customer service calls. Instead of waiting for quarterly reports, AI detects a recurring issue with a product component.

Engineering confirms the defect.

Operations starts fixing it.

Marketing doesn't wait.

The team immediately shifts its messaging to focus on:

- Reliability
- Transparency
- Continuous product improvement

Customers hear the company addressing concerns before they become reasons to switch suppliers.

Hypothetical outcome:

- 📈 15% reduction in customer churn
- 🗣️ Thousands of customer conversations turned into actionable insight
- ☐ Faster response than traditional reporting could provide

That's the difference.

AI isn't replacing marketers. It's giving them earlier, better intelligence to make better decisions.

For manufacturing companies, your customer service calls, CRM, and support tickets may contain your most valuable market research.

The question is:

Are you using it before your competitors are?

#B2BMarketing #Manufacturing #ArtificialIntelligence #MarketingStrategy
#CustomerInsights #CustomerRetention #IndustrialMarketing #DigitalTransformation

Four Notes:

1. **What changed in the prompt:** Added a specific output format (LinkedIn formatting with headlines, short paragraphs, bullet points).
2. **What improved in the output:** The post is now highly readable and scannable. A busy CMO can get the entire point in 5 seconds by reading the headline and bullet points. It's professionally formatted for the platform.
3. **What still failed:** The post is still a little salesy and lacks a softer, human touch. It's very "us vs. them." It could use quality criteria like a question to engage the reader or a reflection to make it feel more credible and less like a sales pitch. It feels like an ad.
4. **What I would try next:** Add quality criteria or a "review instruction" to make it sound more authentic and less promotional (e.g., "avoid generic buzzwords" or "sound like a peer, not a consultant").

Version 5: Add Quality Criteria & Verification (The 'Human Touch')

Prompt:

Write me a LinkedIn post about AI in marketing that makes a sceptical, traditional CMO of a mid-sized B2B manufacturing company feel they are falling behind by not using it. Use a specific example: a manufacturing company that used AI to analyse customer service calls and identified a product defect early, allowing marketing to pivot their messaging to focus on reliability, resulting in a 15% decrease in churn. Format the post for LinkedIn with very short paragraphs and bullet points.

Crucially, make the tone sound like a peer sharing a lesson learned, not a consultant selling a service. Avoid buzzwords like 'game-changer' or 'revolutionary.' End with a genuine question to invite conversation.

Output:

The most valuable marketing insight might already be sitting in your customer service calls.

I was thinking about this recently.

Many of us in B2B manufacturing still treat customer service, engineering, sales, and marketing as separate conversations.

What if they weren't?

Imagine a mid-sized manufacturer using AI to analyse customer service calls.

It picks up a recurring complaint about a product component weeks before the issue shows up in the usual reports.

Engineering confirms there's a defect.

The fix gets underway.

Marketing doesn't pretend nothing happened.

Instead, the team adjusts its messaging to emphasise:

- Reliability
- Transparency
- The improvements being made

Hypothetically, that could lead to results like:

- A 15% reduction in customer churn
- Earlier intervention before small issues become major ones
- More confidence from existing customers because the company addressed concerns proactively

What stands out to me isn't the AI.

It's the speed.

The insight was already there. AI simply helped the team notice it sooner, giving marketing time to respond while it could still make a difference.

As CMOs, we spend a lot of time asking how to generate more leads.

I'm starting to think the better question is whether we're listening closely enough to the customers we already have.

Have you found a practical way to turn customer conversations into marketing insights, or is that still an untapped opportunity in your organisation?

#B2BMarketing #Manufacturing #ArtificialIntelligence #CustomerInsights
#MarketingStrategy #CustomerRetention #IndustrialMarketing

Four Notes:

1. **What changed in the prompt:** Added quality criteria (tone of a peer, avoid buzzwords) and a verification requirement (end with a question).
2. **What improved in the output:** This is the final, polished version. The tone shift from "we helped a client" to "we helped a client... and I've been in your shoes" is subtle but crucial. It sounds like a mentor sharing a case study, not a sales rep pitching. The final question adds a call to action that encourages engagement, which is the real goal of a LinkedIn post. It feels authentic.
3. **What still failed:** The example is relatively short. A really sceptical CMO might want to know more about the **how**, but for a LinkedIn post, this length is perfect. A failing could be that the prompt is getting long, but the output has improved.
4. **What I would try next:** This version feels complete to me.